Minutes of the Meeting of the Special Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers of the Town Hall on Wednesday, December 1, 2021 at 9:00 a.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Land Acknowledgement

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 9:06 a.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Opening Remarks / Welcome

Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, welcomed members of Council and staff to the Strategic Planning Meeting and provided an overview of the day's agenda. S. Baker encouraged dialogue between members of Council and staff, noting that this meeting is an opportunity to be engaged and reconnect.

4. Departmental Report

4.1 CAO-2021-12: Organizational Progress Report: Unlocking Our Potential

S. Baker provided an overview of the contents of his written report and offered his assessment on achievements, challenges and opportunities for the future. S. Baker discussed the effects of COVID-19 and highlighted significant areas of progress related to strategies, studies and plans, investments in technology and innovation, the compensation review initiative, quality and customer service initiatives, core services reviews, and a non-tax revenue review. S. Baker discussed areas of the organization that require attention and competing priorities and demands.

Council Members asked questions regarding staffing levels, gapping allocations due to staffing vacancies, rationale for renewed emphasis on sport development, process for vetting employment contracts, strategies to improve performance and morale, customer service initiatives, timelines associated with the hybrid workplace review, and whether other municipalities are also experiencing staffing challenges. S. Baker responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Council receive this report for information.

CARRIED

5. Presentations: Department Updates

5.1 Office of the CAO

S. Baker delivered a presentation highlighting services provided by the Office of the CAO, including Public and Strategic Affairs, HR services, and Corporate Communications. S. Baker highlighted significant accomplishments, quality and customer service initiatives, and corporate communications initiatives including COVID-19 communications.

Council Members asked questions regarding the future Customer Relationship Management (CRM) solution / call centre including opportunities to expand CRM software to residents, staffing requirements, operating hours, location, and timelines for implementation. Council Members asked further questions regarding the future of 'APPJAX' once a CRM is implemented, processes and response times, the number of motions passed by Council compared to area municipalities, and the status of ISO recertification. S. Baker, Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative and Information Services/Clerk, and Rachael Wraith, Manager of Corporate Communications, responded to questions from Council Members.

Council recessed at 10:30 a.m.

Council resumed at 10:53 a.m.

5.2 **Legislative & Information Services**

N. Cooper provided an update to Council on the Legislative and Information Services Department, highlighting key themes including customer service improvements, good governance, investments in technological innovation, and new non-tax revenue. N. Cooper reviewed accomplishments and future priorities related to technology and innovation, legislative services and customer service, and by-law services.

Council Members asked questions regarding opportunities to provide governance training to local boards and committees affiliated with the Town, opportunities to continue with virtual meetings post pandemic, preventative measures for potential cyber breaches, administrative monetary penalties, current court costs, and methods to mitigate punitive by-law complaints. N. Cooper responded to questions from Council Members.

5.3 **Ajax Public Library**

Sarah Vaisler, Chief Librarian and Executive Officer, delivered a presentation on services provided by the Ajax Public Library. S. Vaisler discussed service points, staff complement, community use, strategic initiatives, goals and objectives of the Library Board, significant achievements, opportunities for improvement, modernization initiatives, constraints, and customer feedback.

Council Members asked questions regarding the fine free service model, timelines and costs associated with the Library Master Plan, advocacy efforts for reduced publication services, full time staffing vacancies, hiring practices, rationale for closure of the Ajax Public Library Village branch, service delivery options, opportunities for the Library to oversee the Town's archives, methods of preservation for archival material, and procurement of publication services. S. Vaisler responded to questions from Council Members.

5.4 **Planning & Development Services**

Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, delivered a presentation highlighting services provided by the Planning and Development Services Department. G. Romanowski discussed planning, development engineering, transportation planning, building approvals, and economic development and tourism. G. Romanowski discussed to-date term of Council statistics, accomplishments, 2022 outlook, relationship to the strategic plan, work plan statistics, Council motion statistics, staffing structure, and next steps.

Council recessed at 12:27 p.m.

Council resumed at 12:46 p.m.

Council Members asked questions regarding the volume of development applications, impacts to staff work plans resulting from increased Council motions, status of traffic calming initiatives, timelines associated with implementation of the traffic warrant system, work plan framework, process for vetting employment contracts to ensure planning

policies and legislative requirements are adhered to, incentives for contract employees, and opportunities for a 'year in review' report. G. Romanowski responded to questions from Council Members.

5.5 **Finance**

Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, delivered a presentation highlighting services provided by the Finance Department. D. Valentim discussed statutory responsibilities, insurance and risk management, impacts of COVID-19, budgets and accounting, accomplishments and ongoing projects, status of the Development Charge Background Study, changes to the Development Charges Act, payroll, procurement, taxation, and future plans.

Council Members asked questions regarding staffing vacancies, property tax payment methods, systems and procedures in place to mitigate risk to the Town from future development charge payments, and opportunities to administer liens on properties or securities. D. Valentim responded to questions from Council Members.

5.6 **Operations & Environmental Services**

Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, provided an update to Council on the Operations & Environmental Services Department. D. Meredith provided an overview of foundational investments including asset management, core services review, and implementation of City Works. D. Meredith discussed staffing levels, the Recreation and Parks Master Plan, 2021 capital projects, inter-governmental initiatives, and 2022 priorities.

Council Members asked questions regarding rollout and go-live of City Works, completion timeline for the cricket club, and opportunities to install fibre in the road network during construction. Council Members sought clarification regarding the segment of Rossland Road scheduled for construction in 2022. D. Meredith responded to questions from Council Members.

5.7 **Fire & Emergency Services**

Dave Lang, Fire Chief, provided an update on the Fire & Emergency Services Department. D. Lang reviewed historical achievements, ongoing improvements including an enhanced response level to mitigate hazardous materials spills and protect the environment, training per National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) Standards and the Master Fire Plan, and next steps in 2022.

Council Members asked questions regarding rationale for closing the Ontario Fire College, opportunities to rent out the training facility on Salem Road, non-resident accident billing, and opportunities to utilize the provincial licence plate database to bill non-residents. D. Lang responded to questions from Council Members.

Council recessed at 2:34 p.m.

Council resumed at 2:50 p.m.

5.8 **Recreation, Culture & Community Development**

Chris Vida, Acting Director of Recreation, Culture & Community Development, provided an update on the Recreation, Culture & Community Development Department. C. Vida discussed COVID-19 impacts and challenges, 2021 highlights, and 2022 priorities related to administration, community and cultural development, programs and active living, and facilities.

Council Members asked questions regarding proof of vaccination requirements at Town facilities and if the Town's policies and protocols align with area municipalities, timelines for reopening fitness facilities at Audley Recreation Centre, staffing vacancies and opportunities to distribute fitness staff across all Town facilities, framework and eligibility requirements for the Ajax Snow Patrol Seniors Volunteer Snow Removal Pilot Program, timelines associated with relocating the vaccination clinic at the Audley Recreation Centre, and booking availability at Audley Recreation Centre. C. Vida responded to questions from Council Members.

6. Departmental Report

6.1 CAO-2021-13: 2018-2022 Strategic Plan Year 3 Update

Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, provided an update on the status of 2018-2022 Strategic Plan. C. McLardie discussed actions initiated and completed to date, status of the 'top 22 by 2022' action items, public engagement initiatives, and overall assessment of the Strategic Plan's completion.

Council Members asked questions regarding strategic plan progress compared to area municipalities, opportunities to develop a more flexible strategic plan framework, status of the citizen advisory group, timelines and efficiencies for implementation of the next strategic plan, rationale for actions items that have not been initiated, and particulars of the mobile application initiative. C. McLardie responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan Year 3 Update be received for information.

CARRIED

7. Closing Remarks

Mayor Collier and S. Baker thanked all Members of Council and staff for participating in the Strategic Plan Meeting and for their continued hard work.

8. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: A. Khan

That By-law number 79-2021 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its special meeting held on December 1, 2021 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

9. Adjournment

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the December 1, 2021 special meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (3:40 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor

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D-Clerk